

SAT Reading & Writing

Form, Structure, and Sense 2

Question #	ID		Answer
2.1	b74f676f	Classical composer Florence Price's 1927 move to Chicago marked a turning point in her career. It was there that Price premiered her First Symphony—a piece that was praised for blending traditional Romantic motifs with aspects of Black folk music—and _____ supportive relationships with other Black artists. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? A. developing B. developed C. to develop D. having developed	B
2.2	684b8bd2	Far from being modern inventions, _____ more than 5,000 years ago. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? A. Sumerians in ancient Mesopotamia used drinking straws B. drinking straws were used by Sumerians in ancient Mesopotamia C. the use of drinking straws by Sumerians in ancient Mesopotamia happened D. ancient Mesopotamia was home to Sumerians who used drinking straws	B
2.3	c52652c9	The human brain is primed to recognize faces—so much so that, due to a perceptual tendency called pareidolia, _____ will even find faces in clouds, wooden doors, pieces of fruit, and other faceless inanimate objects. Researcher Susan Magsamen has focused her work on better understanding this everyday phenomenon. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? A. she B. they C. it D. those	C
2.4	36944347	Official measurements of the Mississippi River's length vary: according to the US Geologic Survey, the river is 2,300 miles long, whereas the Environmental Protection Agency records its length as 2,320 miles. This disparity can be explained in part by the fact that rivers such as the Mississippi expand and contract as _____ sediment. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? A. they accumulate B. one accumulates C. it accumulates D. we accumulate	A
2.5	8d53e7a0	Slam poet Elizabeth Acevedo's debut novel <i>The Poet X</i>, winner of the 2018 National Book Award for Young People's Literature, is composed of _____ protagonist, fifteen-year-old Xiomara Batista. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? A. poems putatively written by the novel's B. poem's putatively written by the novel's C. poem's putatively written by the novels' D. poems putatively written by the novels'	A

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2.6	0bcb4417	Oglala Lakota poet Layli Long Soldier's star quilt poems offer an unusually open-ended reading experience. With _____ eight panels of text stitched together in the shape of a traditional eight-pointed Lakota star quilt, the poems present viewers with a seemingly infinite number of ways to read them. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? A. their B. it's C. they're D. its	A
2.7	c8607bdf	"Praise Song for the Day," Elizabeth Alexander's 2009 inaugural poem, asserts that "We cross dirt roads and highways...to see what's on the other side." Alexander's use of "we" _____ Americans' collective efforts and shared desire to seek new opportunity. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? A. evokes B. are evoking C. have evoked D. evoke	A
2.8	db2e480a	By the time Hawaiian king Kamehameha III _____ the throne, the number of longhorn cattle, first introduced to the islands in 1793, had drastically increased, and so too had the need for <i>paniolo</i> (Hawaiian cowboys) to manage the wild herds that then roamed throughout the volcanic terrain. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? A. ascended B. will ascend C. ascends D. is ascending	A
2.9	a30567fd	Nuhād al-Ḥaddād, known as Fairuz, was one of the most beloved Lebanese singers of the twentieth century. Her broad singing repertoire—which included traditional forms, such as the Arabic <i>qasida</i> and <i>maqam</i>, alongside modern pop and jazz styles—lent Fairuz a timeless, cross-generational appeal, _____ her the moniker "the soul of Lebanon." Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? A. earned B. had earned C. earning D. earn	C
2.10	cd2443c0	A pioneer in the field of taphonomy (the study of how organic remains become fossils), _____ may be just as prevalent in the fossil record as those of thick-shelled organisms. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? A. fossils of thin-shelled organisms, Anna Behrensmeyer demonstrated in a 2005 analysis, B. Anna Behrensmeyer demonstrated in a 2005 analysis that fossils of thin-shelled organisms C. it was demonstrated in a 2005 analysis by Anna Behrensmeyer that fossils of thin-shelled organisms D. a 2005 analysis—by Anna Behrensmeyer—demonstrated that fossils of thin-shelled organisms	B

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2.11	e44db0a0	Because a cycle of lunar phases _____ 29.5 days to complete, it's possible to observe two full moons in a single month, one at the beginning and one at the end. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? A. are taking B. have taken C. take D. takes	D
2.12	67614549	After winning the 1860 presidential election, Abraham Lincoln appointed Edward Bates, Salmon P. Chase, and William H. Seward to his cabinet. Lincoln's decision was surprising, since each of these men had run against him, but historians have praised it, noting that Lincoln _____ his rivals' diverse talents to strengthen his administration. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? A. has leveraged B. is leveraging C. will leverage D. leveraged	D
2.13	28166dc6	_____ In knot theory (the mathematical study of curved, closed loops), knots are characterized by their crossing numbers—that is, the number of times the knotted thread crosses over itself. The trefoil knot and the figure-eight knot, each with a crossing number below five, _____ among the simplest possible knots with the fewest number of crossings. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? A. was B. are C. has been D. is	B
2.14	d2cf0e11	Inventor John Friedman created a prototype of the first flexible straw by inserting a screw into a paper straw and, using dental floss, binding the straw tightly around the _____. When the floss and screw were removed, the resulting corrugations in the paper allowed the straw to bend easily over the edge of a glass. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? A. screw's thread's. B. screws' threads. C. screw's threads. D. screws threads'.	C
2.15	b85c19ed	The violins handmade in the seventeenth century by Italian craftsman Antonio Stradivari have been celebrated as some of the finest in the world. In close collaboration with musicians, Stradivari introduced changes to the shape of a traditional violin, flattening some of the instrument's curves and making _____ lighter overall. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? A. those B. one C. them D. it	D

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2.16	7a0d9031	In many of her landscape paintings from the 1970s and 1980s, Lebanese American artist Etel Adnan worked to capture the essence of California's fog-shrouded Mount Tamalpais region through abstraction, using splotches of color to represent the area's features. Interestingly, the triangle representing the mountain itself _____ among the few defined figures in her paintings. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? A. are B. have been C. were D. is	D
2.17	59209b6d	Based on genetic evidence, archaeologists have generally agreed that reindeer domestication began in the eleventh century CE. However, since uncovering fragments of a 2,000-year-old reindeer training harness in northern Siberia, _____ may have begun much earlier. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? A. researcher Robert Losey has argued that domestication B. researcher Robert Losey's argument is that domestication C. domestication, researcher Robert Losey has argued, D. the argument researcher Robert Losey has made is that domestication	A
2.18	6e193b19	Professional American football player Fred Cox invented one of the world's most popular toys. In the 1970s, he came up with the idea for the Nerf football, which _____ of the harder and heavier regulation football. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? A. were a smaller, foam version B. are smaller, foam versions C. were smaller, foam versions D. is a smaller, foam version	D
2.19	dd6a0326	African American Percy Julian was a scientist and entrepreneur whose work helped people around the world to see. Named in 1999 as one of the greatest achievements by a US chemist in the past hundred years, _____ led to the first mass-produced treatment for glaucoma. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? A. Julian synthesized the alkaloid physostigmine in 1935; it B. in 1935 Julian synthesized the alkaloid physostigmine, which C. Julian's 1935 synthesis of the alkaloid physostigmine D. the alkaloid physostigmine was synthesized by Julian in 1935 and	C
2.20	b8e13a74	Josephine Paddock and Florence Esté were among the 300 artists who exhibited at the 1913 Armory Show, a groundbreaking New York City art exhibition that introduced modernism to American audiences. Though shocking at the time, an abstract cubist painting exhibited by Marcel Duchamp—one of several works that received scorn from critics—_____ the Western art canon more than a century later. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? A. has entered B. have entered C. were entering D. enter	A

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2.21	a03008de	The Proto-Nilotic language, common ancestor of fifty-five African languages with similar linguistic properties, _____ like all protolanguages, hypothetical: there's no direct evidence these ancestral languages actually existed. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? A. is, B. are, C. have been, D. were,	A
2.22	20a6a4ed	Anthropologist Lívia Barbosa, of the Universidade Federal Fluminense in Brazil, _____ food and sociability in contemporary Brazil—specifically, how foods such as cabidela (a rice and rabbit dish) and churrasco (a barbeque dish) function as central mechanisms in building social relationships, values, and identities. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? A. studies B. are studying C. have studied D. study	A
2.23	003f22c8	Every last second of space shuttle mission STS-79, which lasted ten days and three hours, _____ carefully monitored by a team of experts. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? A. have been B. are C. was D. were	C
2.24	819c443d	In January 1776, Thomas Paine published <i>Common Sense</i>, an appeal for freedom from the British monarchy that famously helped ignite the desire for independence among the American colonists. After the colonies achieved their independence, Paine moved to Paris, where the provocative _____ would contribute to another revolution—the French Revolution. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English? A. authors political writings B. author's political writings C. author's political writing's D. authors' political writings'	B